

Word family: **jungle / jungles / jungle-like**

Base word: jungle

Plural: jungles

Related form / useful extension: jungle-like

Useful expressions / extensions: concrete jungle, jungle law, jungle warfare, jungle gym

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / adjective-like modifier in compounds (複合詞修飾用法)

Your sentence:

> “One minute, the living room becomes a space station, and the next it turns into a **jungle**, a castle, or even a rescue centre.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **jungle** means:

> **a dense tropical area covered with thick vegetation, trees, and plants**

Leo imagines the living room transforming into a wild tropical environment.

繁體中文： ** **熱帶叢林；長滿濃密樹木和植物的野外地區

**中文翻譯： **

> “The living room ... turns into a jungle...”

「客廳.....變成了一片**熱帶叢林**.....」

Here:

jungle = 植被非常茂密、野生而難以穿越的熱帶地區

1. **jungle = dense tropical forest (熱帶叢林) — 叢林；熱帶密林**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The living room ... turns into a **jungle**.”

「客廳.....變成了一片**熱帶叢林**。」

Practice 2

> “They travelled through the ****jungle**** for three days.”

「他們穿越****叢林****走了三天。」

Practice 3

> “Many animals live deep in the ****jungle****.”

「很多動物生活在****叢林深處****。」

****jungle = 長滿非常茂密植物、樹木和藤蔓的熱帶野外地區****

2. ****jungle = wild, overgrown vegetation (雜草叢生之地) — 茂密雜亂的植物區****

A broader literal extension.

Practice 4

> “The garden had become a ****jungle****.”

「那個花園已經變得像一片****雜草叢生的叢林****。」

Practice 5

> “Behind the house was a ****jungle**** of weeds.”

「房子後面是一大片****雜草叢生的地方****。」

****jungle = 植物生長得極度茂密、雜亂、難以穿行的地方****

This does not have to be a literal tropical rainforest.

3. ****jungle = chaotic/confusing place (混亂環境) — 混亂的地方；複雜環境****

A common figurative meaning.

Practice 6

> “The city can feel like a ****jungle****.”

「這座城市有時讓人感覺像一個**混亂又複雜的地方**。」

Practice 7

> “The online marketplace is a **jungle** for inexperienced buyers.”

「對沒有經驗的買家來說，網上市場就像一個**複雜混亂的叢林**。」

jungle = 規則不清、競爭激烈、資訊繁雜或令人難以應付的環境

4. **jungle = highly competitive environment (弱肉強食的環境) — 激烈競爭環境**

Practice 8

> “The fashion industry can be a **jungle**.”

「時裝業有時是一個**競爭極激烈的環境**。」

Practice 9

> “Surviving in the corporate **jungle** requires confidence.”

「要在企業**競爭叢林**中生存，需要有自信。」

jungle = 競爭非常激烈、缺乏安全感、每個人都要努力保護自己利益的環境

This often carries a “survival” flavour.

5. **concrete jungle (石屎森林) — 高樓密集的都市環境**

A very common figurative compound.

Practice 10

> “He wanted to escape the **concrete jungle**.”

「他想逃離這個**石屎森林般的城市環境**。」

Practice 11

> “The district has become a **concrete jungle**.”

「這個地區已經變成一片**高樓密集的石屎森林**。」

concrete jungle = 建築物、道路和石屎結構非常密集、缺乏自然空間的城市環境

The metaphor is:

> dense vegetation → dense buildings

6. **law of the jungle (叢林法則) — 弱肉強食；強者生存**

A major idiomatic expression.

Practice 12

> “The company should not operate by the **law of the jungle**.”

「公司不應該按照**弱肉強食的叢林法則**運作。」

Practice 13

> “Without rules, it becomes the **law of the jungle**.”

「沒有規則，就會變成**弱肉強食**。」

law of the jungle = 沒有公平規則，較強者靠力量取得優勢的狀況

7. **jungle warfare (叢林戰) — 叢林作戰**

Practice 14

> “The soldiers trained for **jungle warfare**.”

「士兵接受**叢林作戰**訓練。」

Practice 15

> “The terrain made **jungle warfare** difficult.”

「地形令**叢林戰**變得困難。」

jungle warfare = 在濃密熱帶植被地區進行的軍事作戰

8. **jungle gym (攀爬架) — 兒童攀爬架**

Especially common in American English.

Practice 16

> “The children climbed on the **jungle gym**.”

「孩子們在**攀爬架**上爬來爬去。」

Practice 17

> “The playground has a large **jungle gym**.”

「遊樂場有一個大型**兒童攀爬架**。」

****jungle gym = 由金屬、木材或其他材料搭成，供兒童攀爬玩耍的架構****

This is lexicalized and does not literally mean a jungle.

9. **jungle-like (像叢林的) — 叢林般的；茂密雜亂的**

Practice 18

> “The garden had a **jungle-like** appearance.”

「那個花園看起來很**像叢林一樣茂密雜亂**。」

Practice 19

> “Dense plants created a **jungle-like** atmosphere.”

「茂密植物營造出一種**叢林般的氣氛**。」

****jungle-like = 在植物密度、外觀或氣氛上像叢林一樣的****

Important distinction: **jungle vs forest**

forest

is the broad term for:

> a large area covered mainly with trees.

jungle

usually suggests:

> dense, tangled vegetation, especially in tropical regions.

So:

forest = 森林

jungle = 茂密叢林

Important distinction: **jungle vs rainforest**

rainforest

is a more ecological/geographical term:

> forest characterized by high rainfall.

jungle

emphasizes:

> tangled, dense vegetation that feels hard to move through.

So not every rainforest area is best called a **jungle**.

Important distinction: **jungle vs woods**

woods

usually means:

> a smaller area of trees, often temperate and easier to walk through.

jungle

suggests:

> denser, wilder vegetation, usually tropical.

Important distinction: **jungle** — literal vs figurative

Literal:

> “They walked through the jungle.”

= 他們穿過熱帶叢林。

Figurative:

> “The market is a jungle.”

= 市場環境複雜而競爭激烈。

The figurative mapping is:

> hard to navigate / hard to survive

> → difficult social or commercial environment

Important distinction: **jungle** vs **chaos**

chaos

= complete disorder/confusion.

jungle

figuratively often adds:

* complexity

* competition

* danger

* survival pressure

So **jungle** is richer than simply “mess.”

Important distinction: **concrete jungle vs city**

city

is neutral.

concrete jungle

is metaphorical and often critical, emphasizing:

- * dense buildings
- * lack of greenery
- * hard urban surfaces
- * crowdedness

Important distinction: **jungle vs wilderness**

wilderness

= wild natural land with little human development.

jungle

= specifically dense vegetation.

A desert can be wilderness, but not normally jungle.

Important distinction: **law of the jungle vs competition**

competition

can be fair and rule-based.

law of the jungle

suggests:

> rules are weak or absent, and strength decides outcomes.

So the idiom is much more negative.

Family-extension note

Jungle is a moderate polysemy word.

Its main semantic centres are:

- * **dense tropical vegetation**
- * **overgrown tangled vegetation**
- * **figurative confusing/chaotic environment**
- * **figurative highly competitive environment**

The most useful extensions are:

- * **concrete jungle**
- * **law of the jungle**
- * **jungle warfare**
- * **jungle gym**
- * **jungle-like**

The figurative “confusing” and “competitive” uses overlap heavily and both come from the same image of a jungle as hard to navigate and survive in, so they should not be over-split. That matches the manual’s conservative semantic-splitting principle.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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jungle — literal tropical	長滿茂密樹木、植物和藤蔓的熱帶野外地區
jungle — overgrown vegetation	植物生長極度茂密、雜亂而難以穿行的地方
jungle — confusing environment	規則不清、資訊繁雜或令人難以應付的複雜環境
jungle — competitive environment	競爭激烈、每個人都要努力保護自己利益的環境
concrete jungle	建築物 and 道路高度密集、缺少自然空間的都市環境
law of the jungle	缺乏公平規則、強者靠力量取得優勢的弱肉強食狀況
jungle warfare	在濃密熱帶植被地區進行的軍事作戰
jungle gym	供兒童攀爬玩耍的架構 / 攀爬架
jungle-like	在外觀、植物密度或氣氛上像叢林一樣的

For your original sentence

> “One minute, the living room becomes a space station, and the next it turns into a **jungle**, a castle, or even a rescue centre.”

The exact meaning is:

****jungle = 長滿茂密植物和樹木的熱帶叢林****

Therefore:

> ****turns into a jungle****

= ****「在 Leo 的想像中變成一片茂密的熱帶叢林」****

This is the literal-environment sense used inside an imaginary transformation.

It is not:

* ****concrete jungle**** = 石屎森林

* ****corporate jungle**** = 競爭激烈的商業環境

* ****law of the jungle**** = 弱肉強食

* ****jungle gym**** = 攀爬架

In the passage, ****jungle**** simply shows the range and vividness of Leo's imagination.